

eral applications open at once, and the laptop simply got on with it. Then I put it to the test with benchmarks.

In Cinebench R23, the laptop scored 31,703 in the multi-core test and 2,340 in the single-core test. That is a strong result, particularly for multi-core. So if you are using the laptop for rendering, compiling, or other CPU-heavy work, there is plenty of processing power.

To test the storage performance, I ran the CrystalDiskMark benchmark. It recorded sequential read speeds of 7,043.70MB/s and write speeds of 6,478.33MB/s. So, large files such as video footage and other project files moved around quickly, with very little time spent staring at a progress bar.

I also ran several synthetic GPU tests on the device. The laptop scored 30,224 in 3DMark Fire Strike, 15,340 in Fire Strike Extreme, and 7,816 in Fire Strike Ultra. In the Port Royal ray tracing test, it scored 7,964. These are impressive numbers for the RTX 5070 laptop GPU.

GAMING EXPERIENCE

Now, benchmarks are one thing. For a gaming laptop, there is only one way to understand what it can actually do.

I started playing 007 First Light at 2560 x 1600 resolution, high graphics settings, and no upscaling. The laptop, in this case, managed around 45 FPS. The game looked gorgeous, but the problem was that it did not feel as smooth as I wanted it to. This became quite obvious once I started moving around as Bond rather than simply looking at the environment.

I then enabled Nvidia DLSS Super Resolution, set it to Balanced, and switched frame generation to 4X. The frame rate jumped to around 180 FPS, and the game felt super smooth. Now, there was a small trade-off. Some reflections did not look quite as impressive as they did with native rendering. But when you are running around while fighting a bunch of robots, you probably won't care how 'shiny' a game looks.

To find a sweet spot, I set Nvidia DLSS to Quality with 2X frame genera-

tion enabled. This brought the frame rate down to around 96 FPS, but the image quality was as good as native.

I also played The Witcher 3 on the Alienware 16X Aurora, and it led to a similar experience. With ray tracing enabled, graphics set to high, 2560 x 1600 resolution, and no frame generation, I was getting around 30 FPS. The game was still playable, and the world looked stunning on the OLED display. But it was still just 30 FPS. When I switched the DLSS on and set it to Balanced mode, I started getting 50 FPS, and the gameplay was a lot smoother without any drop in image quality.

I then tried DLSS at its maximum performance setting, which pushed the frame rate to around 80 FPS. But in this case, the visual quality trade-off was quite visible. The game still looked great, but if you are particular about image quality, you will notice the difference.

I also tested Minecraft with shader packs, and the laptop managed around 60 FPS. That is a good result considering how quickly some shader packs can bring even the most powerful gaming laptops to their knees.

So, the Alienware 16X Aurora is capable enough to play the latest AAA games at 2560 x 1600 resolution, but you should not expect every new title to run at maximum graphics settings and soaring high FPS without using technologies such as Nvidia DLSS.

THERMALS AND BATTERY

All this gaming performance comes with a noticeable amount of heat. After playing 007 First Light for around an hour, the CPU temperature reached 105 degrees Celsius. That is quite high, and it is something I would keep in mind if you plan to run demanding games for several hours at a time.

Even when I was not gaming, temperatures hovered around 80 degrees during my testing. As for the surface temperatures, it gets quite hot. But never too hot to stop using the keyboard.

Now, let's talk about something that gaming laptops are notoriously

famous for: battery life. And as you would expect, the Alienware 16X Aurora is not a device that comes with a great battery life when you are gaming. But when you are using it for work, you can still get a decent bit in before looking for a charger.

I started using the Alienware 16X Aurora at 8 AM on a Monday, and my work involved typing on Google Docs, browsing the web, and watching a couple of YouTube videos. By 12 PM, the battery had dropped to 30 per cent, and the Energy Saver kicked in. By 3 PM, the laptop ran out of juice, and I reached for a charger. So, I basically got around 6 hours of battery life while working on this device, which is not bad at all.

PS: The keyboard backlight was turned off, display brightness was set to 30 per cent, and the laptop was running in Balanced mode. Altering any of these settings would also impact how much battery life you get from the device.

VERDICT

Coming to the Rs 3 lakh question: who exactly is this laptop for? If you want strong performance without going all the way up to machines costing over Rs 5 lakh, you should sneak a peek. And if you have the budget and want something that can double up as your work laptop while looking the part, you could consider the Alienware 16X Aurora.

– Divyanshi Sharma

SPECIFICATIONS

CPU: Intel Core Ultra 9 290HZ Plus | GPU: NVIDIA RTX 5070 8GB VRAM | RAM: 32 GB DDR5 | Storage: 1 TB PCIe NVMe | Display: 16-inch WQXGA OLED panel | Refresh Rate: 240 Hz | Battery: 96 Whr 6-Cell

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